

AI Foundations for Commercial Real Estate

Proper use of AI in CRE and Marketing

This training helps teams understand what AI is, where it fits in commercial real estate marketing workflows, how to use it responsibly, and how to prompt effectively enough to begin producing useful work immediately.

Session Objectives

By the end of this session, I want you to:

- Understand the practical role of AI in CRE marketing and brokerage support
- How to use AI responsibly
- Know the strengths and best uses of the selected tools
- Understand basic data security and safe-use standards
- Write better prompts with more consistency
- Begin thinking in workflows, not one-off tasks

Key Points

- AI is not replacing expertise; it is accelerating execution
- Better output still depends on human judgment
- The goal is not to use AI for everything
- The goal is to use AI where it saves time, improves quality, or increases consistency

Tool Orientation and Selection

Every tool has a job. Teams will become more effective when they stop forcing one tool to do everything. Tool selection should be based on the task.

ChatGPT

First publicly available, cross-discipline usability

Good for:

- Content creation
- Rewriting and adapting messaging
- Brainstorming
- Summarization
- Spreadsheet interpretation
- Workflow building

Claude

Cross-discipline usability, considered the best creative writing

Good for:

- Document review
- Summarization
- Careful analysis
- Contract and document parsing
- Connecting to applications

Gemini

Cross-discipline usability

Good for:

- Broad synthesis
- Document handling
- Workspace-adjacent use cases
- Comparative drafting and idea generation
- Google environment and other applications

Perplexity

Initially started as a platform using ChatGPT and Claude, eventually built own LLM

Good for:

- Research
- Web search
- Document review
- Summarization
- Careful analysis

Microsoft Co-pilot

Cross-discipline usability

Good for:

- Microsoft environment and applications
- Document review
- Summarization
- Careful analysis

Midjourney

Image generation

Good for:

- Image Generation
- Visual concept generation
- Moodboards
- Early-stage marketing imagery concepts
- Style exploration

Gamma

Presentations and marketing collateral

Good for:

- Marketing collateral drafting
- Fast presentation drafting
- Turning ideas into deck structures
- Internal and client-facing visual communication

HeyGen

Video and Presentation

Good for:

- AI-assisted video content
- Scaled video messaging
- Explainer or overview content
- Presentation enhancement

Runway

Video creation

Good for:

- Video
- Storyboarding

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Understanding Security Standards

Safe use of AI tools is paramount to any organization. This is especially true in commercial real estate where deal privacy can be a key component of the process. Projecting client data is vital to AI usage.

Key Knowledge

- Safe use of AI in a commercial real estate environment
- What should and should not be entered into public AI systems
- How to protect client, tenant, investor, legal, and internal information
- Develop an company AI policy

Keep In Mind

Never assume a tool is safe for confidential material by default

Avoid Inputting

- Non-public financial information
- Confidential lease terms
- Private client communications
- Protected personal information
- Proprietary strategy documents
- Redact when possible
- Use anonymized or sample data for certain tasks
- Keep a human in the loop for legal, financial, and strategic outputs
- AI can support review, but it should not serve as final authority

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Prompting Fundamentals

Prompting AI isn't magic. It requires your own knowledge and expertise to make it truly shine. These tools are amazing but without you and thoughtful prompting they can do nothing.

R.I.S.E

Role

Give the AI a role (i.e. Copywriter, Data Analyst, etc.)

Information

Provide information, context, give facts, data, and details of the project. The more detailed the better the results.

Specify

Identify the audience, any constraints, then indicate what results should look like such as format and goals.

Edit

Edit the results after you review. Never release AI generated content without review and human oversight.

Example framework

— Act as a commercial real estate marketing strategist. Write a property description for a Class A office redevelopment in Atlanta aimed at tenant reps and prospective tenants. Keep the tone professional, confident, and concise. Emphasize walkability, upgraded amenities, and flexible floorplates. Provide three versions: website, flyer, and email.”

Key Points

- Weak prompts create vague output
- Better context usually produces better results
- Prompting is less about magic wording and more about clear direction
- Iteration is part of the process
- AI works best when treated like a junior assistant with speed, not judgment

Concepts to Remember

- Ask for multiple versions
- Using step-by-step instructions
- Telling the tool what to avoid
- Requesting structured outputs
- Asking the tool to refine based on critique

Exercise

Improve this prompt — “Write a flyer for this property.”

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Training AI and Creating Workflows

Processes for repeated use with AI will create efficiencies, expand your teams abilities and reach across the market and available platforms.

Training AI on Your Company

You can train an AI model by providing it with relevant company information, documents and past marketing materials. Storing this information in the model for it to reference allows it to arrive closer to a usable product sooner. Without this training you're basically starting from square one each time.

Information for Training

- Company website
- Brand style guidelines
- Past marketing collateral such as flyers, brochures, and OMs
- Writing samples like blogs or articles
- Social media posts

Key Points

- Store information in the model via Projects or Customization
- Schedule periodic updates of training information

AI Workflow Basics

Think beyond isolated prompts and start building repeatable workflows.

AI becomes most valuable when it is part of a sequence such as:

Example CRE marketing workflow

- Gather property facts
- Use AI to draft a description
- Refine tone and audience fit
 - ♦ Adapt into flyer copy
 - ♦ Adapt into email copy
 - ♦ Adapt into social content
- Review and approve
- Save the prompt pattern for reuse

Example document workflow

- Upload or paste redacted text
- Ask for:
 - ♦ Summary
 - ♦ Key clauses
 - ♦ Risks or unusual points
 - ♦ Structured review output
- Human review and finalize

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